Project Plan
ClassMate

Industry Partner	N/A
Primary Instructor	Professor Laily Ajellu
Team Member	Penny Ahlstrom
Team Member	James Jones
Team Member	Omar McIntosh
Team Member	Nezihe Tekin

Document Revision History

Revision #	Date
2.7 (sprint.week)	2025-10-22

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1. Executive Summary

The following describes the project to be executed.

Objective	The ClassMate project aims to design and develop a web-based student life management platform that streamlines academic planning and organization. Through integrated features such as grade tracking, assignment scheduling, progress monitoring, and customizable notifications, the system will enable students to manage their coursework and deadlines. The goal is to enhance productivity and support academic success through a unified, intuitive interface.
Corporate Goals Addressed	This initiative aligns with ClassMate's commitment to delivering innovative, user-centered solutions that meet the evolving needs of students. By introducing a flexible and scalable academic management system, the project supports the company's strategic objective of building sustainable, adaptable tools that can grow alongside its user base and adapt to emerging educational trends.
Planned Start Date	Monday, January 5, 2026
Planned End Date	Friday, April 10, 2026

2. Project Approvers, Reviews and Distribution List

Approvers, reviewers and distribution list

Project Role	Name	E-mail	Date
Primary Instructor	Laily Ajellu	laily.ajellu@georgebrown.ca	
Team Member	Penny Ahlstrom	penny.ahlstrom@georgebrown.ca	
Team Member	James Jones	james.jones@georgebrown.ca	
Team Member	Omar McIntosh	omar.mcintosh@georgebrown.ca	
Team Member	Nezihe Tekin	nezihe.tekin@georgebrown.ca	

3. Scope

Define the sum total of all of its products and their requirements or features.

In Scope	Out of Scope
Allow students to easily view and analyze their overall academic progress to stay informed and motivated throughout the semester.	Financial tools are excluded to maintain focus on academic productivity rather than financial management.
Offer an organized interface for tracking assignments, exams, and deadlines to help students prioritize tasks and manage their workload effectively.	Communication features will be deferred to a later phase to reduce project complexity and maintain academic focus.
Provide timely notifications for upcoming deadlines and events to encourage consistency and reduce missed submissions.	External integrations are excluded to avoid dependency and ensure the MVP remains stable and self-contained.
Deliver a guided introduction for first-time users, ensuring they can understand the system's core features without additional assistance.	Predictive insights and data-driven recommendations will not be included in the MVP release.
Release a functional MVP version showcasing essential features that represent the ClassMate brand vision and serve as a foundation for future updates.	The MVP will be optimized for web use, with future consideration for mobile platforms.

4. Deliverables

This project will deliver the following:

Deliverable	Description
Course and Assessment Management	A centralized system that allows students to manage their courses, assignments, and grades efficiently. It reduces administrative steps and promotes better oversight of academic progress.
Graphical User Interface with Calendar	An intuitive visual dashboard with calendar integration that highlights upcoming tasks and deadlines, helping students plan their workload and stay on schedule.
Multi-Time Zone Display	Enables students to view schedules and deadlines in multiple time zones, ensuring accurate planning

	for international students or those with varied locations.
Event-Driven Notification System	Sends timely alerts for key academic dates such as deadlines, exams, and course drop periods, promoting proactive management and reducing missed tasks.
Customizable User Interface	Offers personalization options including dark mode, adjustable color themes, and scalable fonts to improve accessibility and user comfort.
Flexible Grade Calculator	A tool that allows students to calculate expected grades based on assignment weightings and rules, helping them make informed academic decisions.

5. Assumptions

This project makes the following assumptions:

- Students possess reliable internet access and devices capable of running the application.
- Users are knowledgeable of their course schedules, deadlines, and academic requirements.
- Academic calendars are available for manual input when necessary.
- Students will engage with the application regularly to manage assignments and academic tasks.
- Devices support notifications, allowing timely alerts and reminders.
- Students prefer digital organization tools over traditional paper-based methods.
- Academic advisors and faculty will review and provide feedback on course summaries as intended.
- The development team understands general student needs to inform design and feature decisions.
- All in-scope features are feasible within the project timeline and resource constraints.
- Out-of-scope features, while feasible, are not required for the MVP.

- Appropriate technology stacks and tools are readily available to support implementation.

- This document communicates goals effectively to both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

- Stakeholders are aligned on project objectives, priorities, and expected outcomes.

6. Dependencies

The following are the internal and external dependencies that will have to be acknowledged and addressed:

- **Team Member Availability**: Timely contributions from all project team members are required for coding, testing, documentation, and integration of system components.
- **Access to Academic Calendar Data**: Accurate course schedules, assignment deadlines, and key academic dates must be available to populate the system and support notifications.
- **Database Population:** A fully populated database containing courses, assignments, and grading information is essential for application functionality and user testing.
- **Version Control / Git Repository**: A shared repository is required to maintain up-to-date code, enable collaboration, and prevent conflicts during development.
- **Device Notification Capabilities**: User devices must support push notifications for timely alerts regarding deadlines, exams, and important events.
- **Student Engagement**: The system's effectiveness depends on active use by students to record tasks, track progress, and respond to notifications.
- **Platform Availability**: The MVP will be deployed on a single web-based platform, which must remain accessible and stable throughout development and testing.

7. Risk Management

Potential Risk	Severity (H/M/L)	Likelihood (H/M/L)	Management Strategy

Unavailability of key team members during critical phases	H	M	Implement a backup plan by cross-training team members, maintain a clear task schedule, and regularly monitor progress to avoid obstacles.
Inaccurate or incomplete academic calendar data	H	L	Verify all data sources, allow manual entry and updates, and perform periodic validation to ensure reliability.
Low student engagement with the application	H	H	Conduct usability testing, create onboarding materials, provide reminders, and gather feedback to improve adoption.
Device limitations affecting notifications	M	M	Test application across common devices, provide fallback notifications via email or dashboard alerts, and maintain troubleshooting instructions.
Delays in populating the database with course and assignment information	M	H	Assign clear data-entry responsibilities, monitor progress weekly, and set contingency deadlines for critical milestones.
Budget constraints impacting feature delivery	L	M	Prioritize MVP features, use cost-effective tools and platforms, and track expenses to prevent overruns.
Technical issues during web platform deployment	M	L	Conduct staging tests, schedule maintenance windows, maintain a bug-tracking process, and implement rapid response protocols.

8. Communication

Reporting

The following reports will be produced:

Report	Audience	Frequency
Project Summary	Instructor, Stakeholders, End-Users	End of sprint / monthly
Project Vision	Instructor, Stakeholders, End-Users, Development team	Once (updated if major changes)

Business Requirements	Instructor, Stakeholders, End-Users, Development team	Initial / when updated
Personas	Development team	Initial / updated if user needs change
User Stories	Development team	Sprint planning / updated regularly
Project Plan	Instructor, Stakeholders, Development team	Once / updated if major changes
Team Charter	Instructor, Stakeholders, Development team	Once (baseline)
Product Backlog	Instructor, Stakeholders, Development team	Continuously updated
Sprint Backlog	Development team	Updated each sprint

Meetings

The following meetings/communication will be established:

Meeting	Purpose	Attendees	Frequency
Sprint 1: Kickoff & Project Selection	Choose final project idea (“ClassMate”) and confirm feasibility.	Full team	Start of Sprint 1 (September 21, 2025)
Sprint 1: Feature Planning	Brainstorm dashboard, grades, and task features for MVP scope.	Full team	Mid-Sprint 1 (September 23, 2025)
Sprint 2: UI/Feature Planning	Define layout for Tasks, Grades, and Summary tabs; outline dashboard flow.	Full team	Start of Sprint 2 (October 7, 2025)
Sprint 2: Review & Reminder Design	Finalize course page design and implement reminder function logic.	Full team	Mid-Sprint 2 (October 14, 2025)

9. Task Listing (WBS – Work Breakdown Structure)

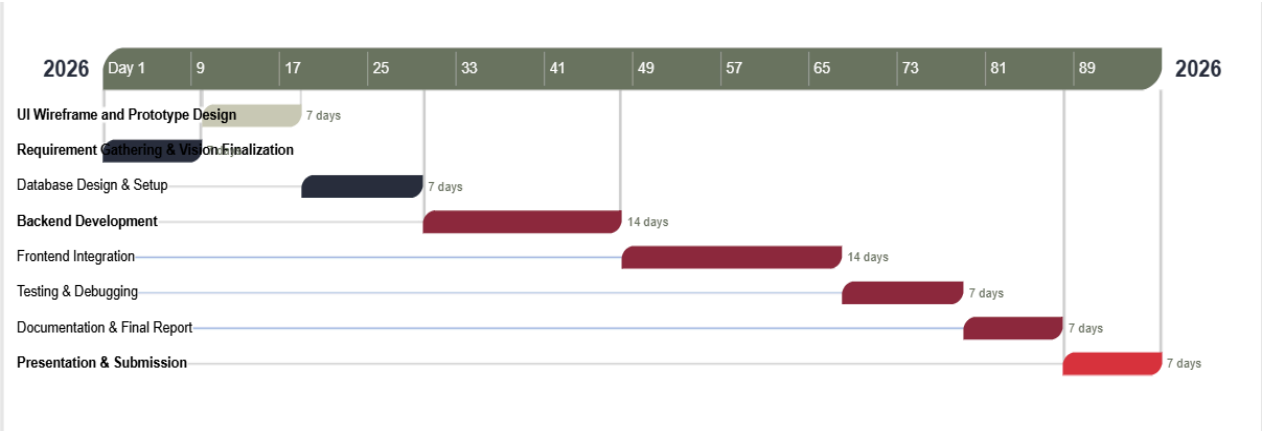
The following resource proposal template summarizes the resource hours committed to this project, upon final approval of this document.

Reference	Tasks	Duration	Dependency

A	Requirement Gathering & Vision Finalization	1 week	-
B	UI Wireframe and Prototype Design	1 week	A
C	Database Design & Setup	1 week	A
D	Backend Development	2 week	C
E	Frontend Integration	2 week	B,D
F	Testing & Debugging	1 week	E
G	Documentation & Final Report	1 week	F
H	Presentation & Submission	1 week	G

10. Gantt Chart

Create a detailed Gantt Chart from your Task Listing(Use any software tool and paste the image or upload as a separate file that can be opened as pdf/doc/xls)



11. Milestones

Major Activity or Milestone	Estimated Milestone Target date	Owner/Reviewer Team Members
Requirement Gathering & Vision Finalization	Jan 13, 2026	*Owner:* Full Team *Reviewer:* Full Team (Penny Ahlstrom, Nezihe Tekin, Omar McIntosh)
UI Wireframe and Prototype Design	Jan 22, 2026	*Owner:* Penny Ahlstrom, Nezihe Tekin *Reviewer:* James Jones

Database Design & Setup	Feb 2, 2026	*Owner:* Omar McIntosh, Penny Ahlstrom *Reviewer:* Nezihe Tekin
Backend Development	Feb 20, 2026	*Owner:* Omar McIntosh, James Jones *Reviewer:* Nezihe Tekin
Frontend Integration	Mar 12, 2026	*Owner:* Penny Ahlstrom, Nezihe Tekin *Reviewer:* James Jones
Testing & Debugging	Mar 23, 2026	*Owner:* James Jones, Nezihe Tekin *Reviewer:* Full Team
Documentation & Final Report	Apr 1, 2026	*Owner:* Penny Ahlstrom, James Jones *Reviewer:* Full Team
Presentation & Submission	Apr 10, 2026	*Owner:* Full Team *Reviewer:* Laily Ajellu

12. RAM – Responsibility Assignment Matrix

Project Team Responsibilities

Project Name: ClassMate

Project Manager: Penny Ahlstrom

Task	Penny	James	Nezihe	Omar
Requirement Gathering & Vision	S	P	S	S

Finalization				
UI Wireframe & Prototype Design	P	S	P	-
Database Design & Setup	S	-	S	P
Backend Development	-	P	S	P
Frontend Integration	P	S	P	-
Testing & Debugging	-	P	P	S
Documentation & Final Report	P	P	S	-
Presentation & Submission	P	P	P	P

P = Primary S = Secondary

13. Approval

The signatures below indicate their approval of the contents of this document.

Project Role	Name	Signature	Date
Team Member	James Jones		October 26, 2025
Team Member	Nezihe Tekin		October 26, 2025
Team Member	Omar McIntosh		October 26, 2025
Team Member	Penny Ahlstrom		October 26, 2025